

Word family: **favourite / favorite / favourites / favorites**

Base word: favourite

American spelling: favorite

Part of speech: **adjective** and **noun**

Useful forms / extensions:

* **favourite** (adj.) — 最喜愛的；最喜歡的

* **favourite** (n.) — 最喜愛的人 / 事物；熱門勝出者

* **favorite** — American spelling

* **a personal favourite** — 個人特別喜愛的人 / 事物

* **an old favourite** — 長久以來一直喜愛的人 / 事物

* **a firm favourite** — 一直深受喜愛的人 / 事物

* **the favourite to win** — 最被看好勝出的人 / 隊伍

* **odds-on favourite** — 大熱門

* **play favourites** — 偏袒某些人

Important family note:

Although **favourite** is historically connected with **favour**, I would **not merge the full favour / favourable / favourably family into this entry**. In modern learner vocabulary, **favourite** behaves as a compact lexical family of its own, while **favour** has a much larger independent polysemy structure.

Meaning in this passage

> My **favourite** teacher from school was my secondary school history teacher, Mr Chan.

Here, **favourite** means:

liked more than all the others of the same type — 最喜愛的；最喜歡的

The speaker had many teachers, but Mr Chan was the one they liked most.

中文翻譯：

我在學校**最喜歡的老師**，是我中學時期的歷史老師陳老師。

So here:

favourite teacher = 在所有老師之中最喜歡的那一位

1. **favourite + noun (最喜愛的) — 最喜歡的 ; 最喜愛的**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> My **favourite teacher** from school was Mr Chan.

我在學校**最喜歡的老師**是陳老師。

Practice 2

> History was my **favourite subject** at school.

歷史是我在學校**最喜歡的科目**。

Practice 3

> What's your **favourite film**?

你**最喜歡的電影**是哪一部？

MCQ-ready definition:

favourite + noun = 在同類人或事物之中最喜歡、最偏愛的

2. **someone's favourite (某人最喜愛的人 / 事物) — 最喜歡的人 / 事物**

Here **favourite** functions as a noun.

Practice 1

> This book is one of my **favourites**.

這本書是我**最喜歡的書之一**。

Practice 2

> Of all the teachers I had, Mr Chan was my **favourite**.

在我所有老師之中，陳老師是我**最喜歡的一位**。

MCQ-ready definition:

someone's favourite = 某人在同類人或事物中最喜歡的一個

3. **one of someone's favourites — 最喜愛的其中之一**

This is very common and slightly different from saying **the favourite**.

Practice 1

> This restaurant is **one of my favourites**.

這間餐廳是我**最喜歡的餐廳之一**。

Practice 2

> That song has always been **one of her favourites**.

那首歌一直都是她**最喜愛的歌曲之一**。

MCQ-ready definition:

one of someone's favourites = 屬於某人最喜愛的一小組人或事物之一

4. **a personal favourite — 個人特別喜愛的人 / 事物**

Practice 1

> This painting is a **personal favourite** of mine.

這幅畫是我**個人特別喜愛的作品**。

Practice 2

> Among his films, this one is a **personal favourite**.

在他的電影之中，這一部是我**個人最喜愛的其中之一**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a personal favourite = 某人個人特別偏愛的人或事物

5. **an old favourite — 長久以來一直喜愛的人 / 事物**

Practice 1

> This song is an **old favourite** of mine.

這首歌是我**多年來一直很喜歡的歌**。

Practice 2

> We returned to an **old favourite** for dinner.

我們晚餐又去了那間**一直很喜歡的老地方**。

MCQ-ready definition:

an old favourite = 長期以來一直受到某人喜愛、經常再次選擇的人或事物

Important: **old** here usually means “long-established as a favourite,” not necessarily physically old.

6. **a firm favourite** — 一直深受喜愛的人 / 事物

Common especially in BrE.

Practice 1

> The dish has become a **firm favourite** with customers.

這道菜已成為顧客**長期非常喜愛的菜式**。

Practice 2

> She is a **firm favourite** with younger viewers.

她一直深受年輕觀眾**喜愛**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a firm favourite = 長期穩定地受到很多人喜愛的人或事物

7. **favourite** (最被看好勝出的人 / 隊伍) — 大熱門 ; 熱門勝出者

This is a genuinely distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> She is the **favourite** to win the race.

她是這場比賽中**最被看好勝出的人**。

Practice 2

> The home team started as the **favourite**.

主隊賽前是**大熱門**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****favourite = 在比賽、選舉或競爭中最被看好會勝出的人、隊伍或選項****

8. ****the favourite to do something — 最被看好會.....****

Practice 1

> He is the **favourite to become captain**.

他是**最被看好會成為隊長的人**。

Practice 2

> The team is the **favourite to win the tournament**.

這支球隊是**最被看好贏得賽事的隊伍**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the favourite to do something = 被普遍認為最有可能取得某個競爭性結果的人或隊伍****

9. ****odds-on favourite — 壓倒性大熱門****

Often used in betting/sports language.

Practice 1

> She entered the final as the **odds-on favourite**.

她以**壓倒性大熱門**身份進入決賽。

Practice 2

> The horse was the **odds-on favourite** to win.

那匹馬是最被看好的****大熱門****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****odds-on favourite = 在投注或競爭中被認為勝出機會非常高的參賽者****

10. ****favourite (特別受寵的人) — 最受寵愛的人；寵兒****

This sense often depends on hierarchy or personal preference.

Practice 1

> He was the teacher's ****favourite****.

他是老師****最偏愛的學生****。

Practice 2

> She was clearly her grandfather's ****favourite****.

她明顯是祖父****最疼愛的人****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****favourite = 在某人心目中特別受喜愛或偏愛的人****

This can be neutral, affectionate, or slightly critical depending on context.

11. ****play favourites — 偏袒；厚此薄彼****

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Good teachers should not ****play favourites****.

好老師不應該****偏袒某些學生****。

Practice 2

> The manager was accused of ****playing favourites****.

那名經理被指****偏袒部分員工****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****play favourites = 不公平地給予某些人較多好處、注意或優待****

12. ****favourite among/with a group — 深受某群體喜愛的人 / 事物****

Practice 1

> The programme is a ****favourite among teenagers****.

這個節目****深受青少年喜愛****。

Practice 2

> This dish is a ****favourite with local customers****.

這道菜是本地顧客的****熱門之選****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a favourite among/with a group = 在某個群體中非常受歡迎、特別受喜愛的人或事物****

13. ****favourite choice / option — 最偏好的選擇****

Usually still built on the core preference sense rather than a completely separate meaning.

Practice 1

> Blue is still the ****favourite choice**** for the walls.

藍色仍然是大家****最喜歡的選擇****。

Practice 2

> This route is the ****favourite option**** among commuters.

這條路線是通勤人士****最偏好的選擇****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****favourite choice/option = 在幾個可選項目之中最受偏愛的一個****

Important distinction 1: ****favourite vs best****

Very important.

****favourite****

= the one you like most.

****best****

= the one judged highest in quality or performance.

> This is my ****favourite**** restaurant.

這是最喜歡的餐廳。

That does ****not necessarily mean****:

> This is the ****best**** restaurant.

這是最好的餐廳。

A favourite is personal; “best” can claim broader quality.

Important distinction 2: ****favourite vs preferred****

****favourite****

usually stronger and more personal/emotional.

****preferred****

often more formal and practical.

> my ****favourite colour****

我最喜歡的顏色

> my ****preferred payment method****

我偏好的付款方式

You would normally not say “my favourite payment method” unless being playful.

Important distinction 3: **favourite vs popular**

favourite

focuses on a person's or group's preference.

popular

means liked by many people.

> This is **my favourite** song.

這是最喜歡的歌。

> This is a **popular** song.

這是一首很受歡迎的歌。

A song can be your favourite without being popular.

Important distinction 4: **favourite vs choice**

favourite

expresses preference.

choice

simply means what someone selects.

Your choice in a situation may not be your favourite if circumstances restrict you.

Important distinction 5: **my favourite vs one of my favourites**

my favourite

usually means number one.

> This is **my favourite** book.

這是最喜歡的一本書。

one of my favourites

means one member of your top group.

> This is **one of my favourite books**.

這是最喜歡的書之一。

The second is less absolute.

Important distinction 6: **favourite adjective vs noun**

Adjective

> my **favourite teacher**

我最喜歡的老師

Noun

> Mr Chan was my **favourite**.

陳老師是最喜歡的一位。

Same semantic idea, different grammar.

Important distinction 7: **favourite to win vs favourite person**

These are genuinely different learner senses.

favourite person

= most liked person

favourite to win

= most expected to win

> She's my **favourite**.

我最喜歡她。

> She's the ****favourite****.

她是大熱門。

Context is essential.

Important distinction 8: ****favourite vs likely****

****likely****

simply means probable.

****favourite****

in competitions means the contestant ****most strongly expected to win relative to the others****.

> He is likely to win.

他很可能會贏。

> He is the favourite to win.

他是最被看好會贏的人。

Important distinction 9: ****favourite vs fan favourite****

****favourite****

can be one person's favourite or the expected winner.

****fan favourite****

specifically means very popular with fans.

> He isn't expected to win, but he's a ****fan favourite****.

雖然大眾不看好他勝出，但他****非常受粉絲歡迎****。

So popularity and competitive probability can diverge.

Important distinction 10: **favourite vs favourite child**

> the **favourite child**

can mean the child a parent appears to like or favour most.

This can carry a negative implication of unequal treatment.

That links naturally to:

> **play favourites**

偏心 / 厚此薄彼

Important distinction 11: **favourite / favorite spelling**

British English

favourite

American English

favorite

Likewise:

* favourites / favorites

The meaning is identical.

Since your passage uses British-style English, **favourite** is the appropriate spelling here.

Important distinction 12: **favourite does not normally take a comparative**

Normally:

* favourite

* my favourite

* one of my favourites

Not normally:

* *more favourite*

* *most favourite*

Because **favourite** already contains the idea of “most preferred.”

However, informal speech occasionally produces expressions like **most favourite**, especially from children, but standard learner English should avoid it.

Important distinction 13: **favourite + singular vs favourite + plural**

Singular

> my **favourite teacher**

usually one top teacher.

Plural

> my **favourite teachers**

a group of teachers you especially like.

So **favourite** can modify plural nouns without meaning each is individually “number one.”

Family-extension note

Favourite has a compact but useful modern polysemy structure.

The two major branches are:

1. **preference**

* favourite teacher

* my favourite

* personal favourite

* old favourite

* firm favourite

2. **competitive expectation**

- * the favourite
- * favourite to win
- * odds-on favourite

There is also an important social extension:

3. **preferential treatment**

- * someone's favourite
- * play favourites

The semantic connection is clear:

****most liked****

→ ****person receiving special preference****

→ in competition, ****the option most people favour as the likely winner****

But for learners, the *****“most liked”***** and *****“most likely to win”***** senses are distinct enough to teach separately.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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favourite teacher	最喜歡的老師	preferred most	
my favourite	我最喜歡的人 / 事物	top preference	
one of my favourites	我最喜歡的其中之一	member of top group	
personal favourite	個人特別喜愛	personal preference	
old favourite	多年來一直喜愛	long-standing preference	
firm favourite	一直深受喜愛	stable popularity	
favourite among/with X	深受 X 喜愛	group preference	
favourite choice	最偏好的選擇	preferred option	
the favourite	大熱門	expected winner	
favourite to win	最被看好勝出	most likely competitor	
odds-on favourite	壓倒性大熱門	strongly expected winner	
someone's favourite	某人最受寵 / 最喜愛的人	specialty favoured person	
play favourites	偏袒；厚此薄彼	unfair preference	
favorite	favourite 的美式拼法	same meaning	

For your original sentence

> My ****favourite teacher**** from school was my secondary school history teacher, Mr Chan.

Here:

favourite = 在所有同類人或事物之中最喜愛的

So:

> **my favourite teacher = 我最喜歡的一位老師**

The speaker is expressing **personal preference and affection**, not claiming Mr Chan was objectively the best teacher in the school.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我在學校**最喜歡的一位老師**，是我中學時期的歷史老師陳老師。

For this passage, the exact sense is the straightforward **“liked more than the others”** meaning of **favourite**.